THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 1

Chapters 13–17: **Saving the Gharial, The Elephant and the Tragopan, That Little Square Box, Marshlands, The Three Caskets** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Why did the team's tiredness matter to the way the author tells the discovery? 1

(a) it proves the trek was pointless
(b) it makes the unexpected nest feel like a lucky reward
(c) it shows they planned to rest
(d) it explains the hyenas

2. Why does the poet make the trout, a water creature, the one who welcomes the reservoir? 1

(a) to show water is dangerous
(b) to show that even apparent gainers will eventually suffer
(c) to prove fish are foolish
(d) to praise dams

3. Why does the author make the narrator unnamed and nervous? 1

(a) to hide his identity from the police
(b) so the reader can share his fears and laugh at them later
(c) to link him to Flannigan
(d) to praise his courage

4. The phrase 'sun-lost lip' most probably suggests that the horizon: 1

(a) is covered by rain **(b)** has no colour at all
(c) is brightly lit by noon sun **(d)** has just lost the sun below it

5. Morocco's request not to be judged by his complexion shows that he is: 1

(a) aware of prejudice and wishes to be seen for his worth
(b) ashamed of his family
(c) uninterested in the test
(d) angry with Portia

6. The shrinkage of range from 20,000 to 200 sq km is about a fall to: 1

(a) one hundredth **(b)** one half **(c)** one tenth **(d)** one thousandth

7. Which of these best describes the elephant's tone while correcting the trout? 1

(a) furious **(b)** patient yet stern
(c) playful **(d)** ashamed

8. Which of these shows dramatic irony? 1

(a) the captain is a spy
(b) readers sense a harmless explanation while the narrator fears death
(c) the men fear the narrator
(d) the narrator knows the truth

9. Which pair of words best captures the poem's overall mood? 1

(a) bitter and angry **(b)** bold and heroic
(c) hushed and peaceful **(d)** loud and cheerful

10. Which statement about Portia is best supported by the story? 1

(a) She leaves Belmont.
(b) She dislikes all suitors.
(c) She keeps her father's rule though it limits her choice.
(d) She secretly helps Bassanio cheat.

11. Which statement about the ghara is an inference rather than a fact stated in the notes? 1

(a) It develops at adolescence
(b) It helps the male win a mate in competition
(c) It is a bulbous growth
(d) It makes a buzz-snort

12. An environmental slogan that best matches the poem is: 1

(a) Roads first, forests later. **(b)** Leave some forest for the animals too.
(c) Bamboo is useless. **(d)** Reservoirs make everyone happy.

13. Which is a likely effect of the narrator's shout 'Stop!'? 1

(a) it exposes his panic to everyone on deck **(b)** it wins the race
(c) it hurts the pigeons **(d)** it prevents an explosion

14. The chief contrast between the first couplets and the last is: 1

(a) bright colour versus grey dimness **(b)** fast versus slow
(c) city versus village **(d)** noise versus music

15. The phrase 'give and hazard all he hath' is most relevant to which life value? 1

(a) ambition **(b)** sacrifice **(c)** thrift **(d)** revenge

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Why do you think the author describes the team as 'tired' just before the discovery? 2

17. Why is the trout's happiness ironic? 2

18. How does the author use ambiguity in 'letting it off'? 2

19. How does the poet turn a damp marsh into a beautiful scene? 2

20. Why does the writer give Morocco a skull and Arragon a blinking idiot? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Discuss how the chapter shows that animals are caring parents. 3

22. Analyse how irony works in the trout's response. 3

23. Discuss how the author uses small clues to build a wrong conclusion. 3

24. Analyse the contrast in lines 3-4 between 'mildew' and 'gold'. 3

OR

Analyse how the inscriptions are designed to trap the unwise. 3

25. How does the author create sympathy for a reptile many people fear? 3

OR

Discuss the idea of 'shared fate' in the poem. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. 'Saving a species means saving its home.' Discuss with reference to the gharial. 5

OR

'The poem is a gentle but firm plea for living in harmony with nature.' Discuss. 5

27. 'Fear thrives where facts are missing.' Discuss with reference to the story. 5

OR

Write a critical appreciation of 'Marshlands'. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND